

Speed Limits

Drivers are required to obey posted minimum and maximum speed limits. These limits are designed to provide for the orderly flow of traffic under normal driving conditions. During periods of heavy traffic, bad weather, low visibility, or other poor driving conditions, you must adjust your speed and following distance to help avoid crashes.

The *Speed Limits* table shows the maximum speed limits for all vehicles under different conditions. Drivers must also be aware cities and counties have the authority to change these limits. Entities that establish or alter a speed limit must establish the same speed limit for daytime and nighttime.

Table 22: Speed Limits

Type of Roadway	Speed (MPH)
Urban District	30
Alley	15
Beaches and County Roads adjacent to a public beach (if declared by the commissioners court of the county)	15
Highway numbered by Texas or the U.S. outside an urban district including Farm to Market and Ranch to Market roads	70
Passenger cars, motorcycles, light truck, passenger car or light truck towing a trailer or semi-trailer, truck or truck-tractor, truck or truck-tractor towing a trailer or semi-trailer, buses, school activity bus.	
School Buses which have passed a commercial vehicle inspection.	
Highway not numbered by Texas or the U.S. and outside an urban district:	60
Passenger cars, motorcycles, light truck, passenger car or light truck towing a trailer or semi-trailer, truck or truck-tractor, truck or truck-tractor towing a trailer or semi-trailer, buses, school activity bus.	
School buses that have not passed a commercial vehicle inspection or are traveling on a highway not numbered by Texas or the U.S.	

The Texas Transportation Commission, regional mobility authorities and local governments have authority to raise or lower speed limits based on traffic studies and other statutory requirements. Many limited access highways have speed limits of 75 up to 85 mph. Always be aware of and observe the posted speed limit for the roadway on which you are driving.

Slow Down or Move Over

If an emergency medical vehicle, law enforcement vehicle, fire truck, tow truck, utility service vehicle, Texas Department of Transportation vehicle (TxDOT, or other highway construction or maintenance vehicle) is stopped on the road with its lights activated (the lights are on or flashing), then the driver is required:

1. To reduce his/her speed to 20 mph below the speed limit; or
2. Move out of the lane closest to the emergency medical vehicle, law enforcement vehicle, fire truck, tow truck or a TxDOT vehicle if the road has multiple lanes traveling in the same direction.

There are other instances where it is important to be observant of vehicles stopped on the road. Mail, delivery, and trash-collection vehicles often make frequent stops in the roadway. Drivers must proceed with caution, and, if possible, change lanes before safely passing one of these vehicles on the road.

Street Racing

Street racing, also known as drag racing, is illegal and can result in serious injuries or fatalities. Illegal street racers put other drivers at risk because races are typically held on public roads. Due to the high speeds, drivers are unable to react to common road hazards or other driving situations, which often results in crashes.

Illegal street racing also causes unnecessary property damage, including extensive wear on roads (due to the high-powered engines damaging asphalt), which requires costly repairs at the expense to the tax-payer.

Please visit the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA) <https://www.nhtsa.gov/risky-driving/speeding> for speed related fatalities.

A person may not participate in:

1. A race;
2. A vehicle speed competition or contest;
3. A drag race or acceleration contest;
4. A test of physical endurance of the operator of a vehicle; or
5. In connection with a drag race, an exhibition of vehicle speed or acceleration, or to make a speed record.

The criminal penalty for a conviction of Speed Racing ranges from a Class B misdemeanor to a second-degree felony.